

Anchor

Your anchor through the storm of a cancer diagnosis.

Mission & Vision | Founded 2026

Our Mission

Anchor exists so that no cancer patient has to navigate the chaos of a diagnosis without the right tools. We believe that when someone hears the words "you have cancer," they deserve to focus on what matters most: their health, their mental wellbeing, and the decisions that shape their treatment. They should not have to spend that energy figuring out insurance deadlines, hunting for financial aid, or drafting legal paperwork from scratch.

Anchor does not replace the patient in their own journey. It equips them. We build tools that reduce the mental burden of everything surrounding a cancer diagnosis, so that patients stay informed, stay in control, and never have to face the overwhelming administrative side of cancer alone.

Why This Matters

A cancer diagnosis is terrifying. But what many people don't talk about is the second wave that follows: an overwhelming flood of administrative tasks, emotional weight, and impossible decisions that arrive at the worst possible moment.

- How do I keep my health insurance? What is COBRA and when does the window close?
- Am I eligible for FMLA? How do I tell my employer I need medical leave?
- Are there financial assistance programs, grants, or government aid I qualify for?
- How do I find a therapist who understands what I'm going through?
- How do I even tell my friends and family that I've been diagnosed?

These are not edge cases. They are the daily reality for millions of newly diagnosed patients. And they come at a time when people are already dealing with depression, fear, and exhaustion. Every unanswered question adds weight to a burden that is already unbearable.

Most patients figure this out alone. Many miss benefits they're entitled to. Some miss deadlines that cost them their insurance. Others suffer in silence because they don't know where to turn for emotional support. Anchor gives them the tools to take it one step at a time.

The Story Behind Anchor

Anchor was born from lived experience, not a business plan.

My father was diagnosed with Stage 4 Non-Hodgkin's Lymphoma. Through his journey, he

became deeply connected to the cancer care world, building relationships with oncologists and navigating the medical system with hard-won knowledge. He fought, and he learned.

In January 2026, it was my turn. I was diagnosed with a Gastrointestinal Stromal Tumor (GIST), a rare cancer that most people have never heard of. Overnight, I was thrown into the same storm my father had faced: finding specialists for a rare disease, battling insurance, tracking documents, managing deadlines, all while dealing with massive waves of depression and fear.

If not for my father, who took on the full burden of the administrative chaos, I would have been completely lost. He became my anchor. He made calls, tracked paperwork, found specialists, and fought insurance battles so that I could focus on one thing: getting through it.

"Not everyone has someone to carry that weight for them. I want to be that for other people."

-- Maia Salti, Founder

That is why I built Anchor. Not to take over the process for patients, but to give them what my father gave me: the tools, the information, and the support to face it without being overwhelmed. With Anchor, every patient has someone in their corner.

Mental Health First

Everything we build at Anchor starts with one question: does this reduce the patient's mental burden?

Cancer patients don't need another app that adds to their plate. They need tools that take things off of it. Every feature in Anchor is designed to give patients clarity, reduce overwhelm, and make the next step obvious. We don't make decisions for patients. We make it easier for them to make their own.

Depression, anxiety, and emotional exhaustion are not side effects of cancer. They are central to the experience. And every missed deadline, every confusing insurance form, every hour spent on hold, every conversation they don't know how to start makes it worse. Anchor is built with the conviction that reducing administrative and emotional stress is a form of mental health care.

What Anchor Gives Patients

After a short onboarding, patients get access to a personalized toolkit built around their diagnosis, insurance, and employment situation. Anchor puts patients in control with tools across four areas:

Administrative Tools

- Action Checklist: a prioritized list of what to do, organized by urgency and category (insurance, employment, financial, legal, medical)
- Deadline Tracker: critical dates with urgency flags so nothing slips through the cracks (COBRA windows, appeal deadlines, enrollment periods)
- Document Generator: auto-generated documents pre-filled with patient info (FMLA requests, insurance appeals, COBRA notices, disability applications, hardship letters)

- Benefits Finder: AI-powered discovery of government programs, employer benefits, pharmaceutical assistance, and nonprofit grants the patient may qualify for

Support & Mental Health

- Find support groups and communities tailored to their diagnosis
- Search for therapists and mental health professionals who specialize in cancer care
- Journal to process emotions, track how they're feeling, and reflect on their journey
- Log side effects and symptoms to share with their care team

Communication Tools

- Conversation scripts: AI-generated messages to help patients tell friends, family, and coworkers about their diagnosis
- Family update sharing so loved ones stay informed without the patient having to repeat themselves

Research & Discovery

- Find clinical trials relevant to their cancer type and stage
- Discover specialists and treatment centers for rare diagnoses

Every tool is designed with the same principle: the patient is always in control. Anchor informs, organizes, and simplifies. The patient decides.

The Vision

Today, Anchor helps cancer patients manage the administrative and emotional weight of their diagnosis. But our vision is much bigger.

We are building the go-to platform that cancer patients turn to from the moment of diagnosis through their entire journey. A single place where they can manage paperwork, find support, track their health, communicate with loved ones, and make informed decisions about their care, all without feeling overwhelmed.

Our north star is simple: Anchor should be the first thing a newly diagnosed patient is told about. The tool that hospitals recommend, that oncologists share, that patients tell each other about because it genuinely made their lives easier during the hardest time they've ever faced.

Anchor. Because no one should face this alone.